ALAGAPPA UNIVERSITY
(Reaccredited with 'A' Grade by NAAC)
KARAIKUDI

Date : 8-9-2016

International Literacy Day-2016

International Literacy Day was celebrated by the Department of Library and Information Science, Alagappa University, Karaikudi, on 8th September, 2016.

Dr. V. Balachandran, Registrar i/c., Alagappa University, in his presidential address said that both the State and Central Governments are making sincere efforts to increase literacy rates among the youth, who form a major chunk of the countryôs population, by granting enormous scholarships and making reservations for the socially and economically disadvantaged sections of the society. The students should make avail of them for their own development and also for contributing to the nationôs growth. Quoting a popular Tamil saying that a king is recognized only in his own country, but a scholar is recognized by people all over the world. In todayôs knowledge economy, he stressed the importance of making reading a daily habit in order to know the happenings around the world. To become a successful student, one has to listen first, then ask questions to ascertain the correctness of his understanding and then write without errors.

He went on to quote a few findings from the Census Report of India - 2011, illiteracy was the highest among the Muslim population. He also quoted that Bihar and Telengana had the lowest literacy rates in India at 63.82% and 66.5% respectively. Adding to the fact that a countryôs development is always evaluated by its literacy rate, he said that in spite of having 37% of the global population, India did not exhibit the required amount of literacy rate. Further, he said that in spite of illiteracy issues, Tamil Nadu contributed to almost 41% of the Gross Enrolment Ratio of the nation.

Dr.A.Ganesan, Director, Knowledge Resource Centre, PRIST University, Thanjavur, delivered the special address. He said ñAccording to higher education statistics, only 2% of the people are getting higher education in India. Also, according to World Bank reports, there is a parallelism between the higher education of a countryôs population and its economic developmentò He appealed to the youth of the nation to take upon themselves the task of spreading the message of literacy for the total development of our country, both social and economic.

Prof. K. Gurunathan, Member of the Syndicate, offered his felicitations. Dr. S.Thanuskodi, Professor and Head, welcomed the gathering and Dr. R. Jeyshankar, Assistant Professor, proposed a vote of thanks.

Prof. V. Balachandran
Registrar i/c.